I'll Tear Down the Sky

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/49467619.

Rating:
Mature

Archive Warnings:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence, Major Character Death

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Minor Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Blood, Blood and Gore, POV Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Catra Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Catra Has Issues (She-Ra), Poor Catra (She-Ra), Catra is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Hurt Adora (She-Ra), Alternate Universe, Crying, Grief/Mourning, Character Death, Implied/Referenced Character Death, Self-Hatred, Survivor Guilt, Character Study, Catra Has Anger Issues (She-Ra), Brutality, Revenge

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Part 2 of Adora Dies (Nothing is the Same)

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by Lukaswritesthings

Summary

(what do you want?)

Catra's reaction and subsequent actions after Adora's brutal death.

Notes

title from God Complex by VIRA, great song

this might be the only other part in this series, might not ¯\(•_•)/¯

Catra stared mindlessly at the wall adjacent to her bed, her hair wild and her eyes red and puffy. Her mind swirled with thoughts and feelings she had never imagined could be possible.

Catra had experienced and seen brutal things before, the Horde made sure of that. She was no stranger to violence and blood, but Adora's dying body haunted her.

With terrifying detail, Catra could recall the smell of blood, the rust and iron filling the air, overpowering the stench of burning flesh and electricity. She could recall the copious amounts of blood escaping Adora's body, the white of bones through the different shades of red that made up Adora's organs. The disgusting, *horrifying* notion that if Adora hadn't gotten there, that could've been Catra. Somehow, though, the reality that it was Adora was even worse.

"Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other."

"You promise?"

"I promise."

Fucking *liar*. They had been together. For a split second, Adora had been touching Catra, and then Adora had been killed. The one person who had truly loved Catra, understood and protected her, and now she was dead. And it was *Catra's fault.* If she hadn't been so careless...

She shouldn't care. She had pushed Adora away. Catra was the reason she couldn't protect the blonde like she always had. But, no matter what she had done or said, Catra had never wanted her ~~best friend~~ to *die.* Sure, Catra had wanted to knock Adora down a peg, prove herself to the other woman, bring her back and rule the Horde together, but... death? Catra would've cut off her own hand before she killed Adora.

The magi-cat clutched her covered arm, gritting her teeth. Her mind fought valiantly against the reminders of her actions, but she

could never win such a losing battle.

The portal. Just remembering it made Catra quake with an overwhelming amount of emotions. Guilt, fear, anger.

"I won't let you win. I'd rather see the whole world end than let that happen."

"Why can't you just stay? We have everything we've ever wanted."

"It's not real!"

Catra felt regret. Regret for pulling the lever, regret for hurting Adora, and, even, regret for sending Entrapta to Beast Island. But she couldn't change anything. Regret didn't do shit. Adora was dead, Entrapta was likely dead, the Rebellion was at it's lowest point, and Hordak was mourning the loss of that *stupid* princess. Everything and everyone was at their worst, including Catra.

This is good.

No it wasn't.

Adora should be dead.

She shouldn't have died.

It was strategic. We did good.

It was terrible. Catra wished the robot had been faster.

She-Ra was gone.

Her best friend was gone. Adora was gone because Catra wanted to win, wanted the Horde to take over. She would never see the blonde again, and it was *her fault.* It was the *Horde's* fault.

Everything Catra had done, she had done it for Adora. She had done it to satisfy her twisted sense of justice for the blonde. But she had failed. She had failed and Adora was dead.

Catra wouldn't fail again.

Standing from her position, Catra wiped her tear-streaked face. She glanced around, reaching under her pillow and pulling out a slim, jagged knife.

This ends now.

-*-

A younger, softer Catra looks into Adora's teary eyes, pursing her lips.

"And you're sure I can't beat her up?" She asks, crossing her arms and tapping her claws against her bicep.

Adora smiles briefly, shaking her head. "I don't want you to get in trouble again."

"Doesn't matter to me. I'd still beat her up." Catra replies, looking away with a sour look on her face. Lonnie really got in her nerves.

Adora places a shaky hand on Catra's shoulder, squeezing tightly. "Just... stay with me tonight?"

Catra stares at her for a second before slinking further onto her bunk, stretching and getting comfortable. The aching burn that urged her to hurt somebody festered in her stomach, but she pushed it down in favor or giving Adora a small, comforting grin. "Sure, dummy."

Adora smiles back, leaning against her pillow and closing her eyes. She looks peaceful, and Catra can't help but stare.

This Catra, young and reckless, thought that doing anything for Adora meant beating someone up and dealing with the consequences.

-*-

This Catra, older and much more broken, feels the burn urging her to violence again, and *knows* doing anything for Adora includes *murder*.

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